Multi Culturalism, Diversity and Process of Nation Building

The new Indian nation evolved during the post-mutiny colonial period, through the national movement, was inspired by past experiences, and emerging ideas of democracy, liberalism and federalism. The age of monarchies were gone forever, the era of religious states too were gone. In an age of liberal democracy, peoples' will, rights and their linguistic, cultural identities, and their economic development have to be the basis of nation building. The great nation builders of modern times like Mahatma Gandhi and Jawaharlal Nehru were against religious or cultural nationalism (Hindu Nationalism, Muslim Nationalism or Two-Nation Theory. They acknowledged the plural base of emerging new India, hence advocated a democratic liberal and federal India. However, many thinkers have pointed out that the constitution of our New India through called India a union of states did not provide adequate financial and political powers for the constituent states. Over centralization along with insistence on a single national-official language (i.e.Hindi) replacing English would erode into the cultural and linguistic identity of the constituent regions. Jawaharlal Nehru could see the perils involved in replacing English with Hindi, hence gave an assurance on the continuance of English as long as the non-Hindi people desired the same.

Activity

Trace the various movements in different cities within Tamil Nadu during the formation of the State. What were the different rallies and protests other than the ones mentioned in the text organised across Tamil Nadu?

Glossary

- **British Commonwealth :** An association of nations involving the United Kingdom and many former British colonies that later became independent states but continue to pledge allegiance to the British Crown are British Commonwealth.
- **Cultural Homogeneity :** A State promoted standardisation of culture that interconnects the States, based on the supposition of establishing an ideal unified community is Cultural Homogeneity.
- **Constituent Assembly :** A body of representatives, who are elected by popular vote, with the objective of creating, changing, or drafting a constitution, i.e. a legal system that determines the fundamental political principles of a government is a Constituent Assembly.
- **Dominion :** A self-governing nation in the British Commonwealth is Dominion.
- **Dravidar Kazhagam :** A revolutionary movement that aimed at streamlining the voice of the Tamils towards social cause and for the upliftment of the Tamils is Dravidar Kazhagam.
- **House of Commons :** The lower house of the Parliament of the United Kingdom, whose members are elected

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